

OpenWrt Linux runs MediaTek board

MediaTek Labs has launched the MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688 development platform. Marc Naddell, VP of MediaTek Labs, has remarked that the company is focused on stimulating innovation in IoT and is pleased to extend its LinkIt family of development platforms to the open source and Web developer communities, enabling broader product development for a more connected world. Keeping to the promise, the MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688 development board has been engineered to provide developers with a wide range of programming options.

The new development board is out in two editions, the MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688 with the MT7688AN based microprocessor unit and MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688 Duo with the MT7688AN based microprocessor unit -- the latter is compatible with the Arduino open source electronic prototyping platform.

Both boards come with built-in Wi-Fi and all the necessary ports for connecting peripherals, 128MB RAM and 32MB internal flash storage. They are fully compatible with open source software, supporting a broad range of Linux kernel based operating systems, such as OpenWrt, and multiple programming languages. The MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688 development board has been designed specifically for OpenWrt and Arduino developers, allowing them to create native C apps for Internet of Things devices, as well as to build software for the microprocessor unit (MPU), using the OpenWrt SDK and Arduino IDE development software, respectively.

Microsoft has applied Chakra in many Windows applications in Xboxes, its phones and operating system. The tech giant asserts that Chakra is faster than rival engines in Google's Chrome and Mozilla's Firefox browsers, as well as its own Internet Explorer 11 browser. ChakraCore is not reliant on gears in the Edge browser in order to parse, understand and assemble JavaScript.

Initially, when it is released in January, ChakraCore will only be accessible for Windows, but there are plans to make it accessible on other platforms as well.

WordPress.com is now a desktop app

Everything is new with WordPress.com. The developers have switched to a new stack using JavaScript and API calls. It is totally different from the earlier version that used PHP and MySQL, and will lead to a fully-working WordPress client that runs in your Web browser.

One can find a single page application with a few loading screens. It is easy to use on the handset to the responsive nature of the update.

The power of open source development is offered with the new update. One can



check out the used code, or even go ahead and reuse it. However, you must ensure that you are within the regulations of the GNU General Public License v2.

The agonising process of rewriting has led to the development of this desktop application. Now,

users of Mac devices can get a desktop WordPress.com application. The new app breeds familiarity with the Slack desktop application.

The application is available for MacOS X users and is soon to be launched for Windows and Linux platforms. The new update implies that WordPress wants to retain its position in the market and remain with its parent company, Automatic.

Newcomers such as Medium were doing much better than WordPress.com, but rewriting the entire site has brought the app's feel and performance to the same level as modern-day Web apps.

Intel's Snap to improve visibility in the cloud

Intel has come up with a new open source project called Snap, specifically designed



to help improve visibility into cloud infrastructure. "Snap happens to be a pluggable open source platform telemetry framework, which can collect and expose data about underlying infrastructure that is running a cloud environment. Being one of the core members of the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF), we can show up in one form or the other," added Jonathan Donaldson, vice president and general manager, software defined infrastructure group at Intel.

For Intel, Snap is an open source effort, but it could help Intel's commercial aspirations as well by way of Jevon's Paradox, since the belief is that as efficiency improves, consumption also grows.